

SENIOR DESIGN PROJECT TEAM CONTRACT

University of Cincinnati | College of Engineering and Applied Science

Project: Using AI Agents to Boost Developer Productivity

This contract establishes the expectations, roles, and communication protocols for the team. All members agree to the terms outlined below.

1. TEAM ROSTER & CONTACT INFORMATION

Name	Email
Maxwell Blevins	blevinmw@mail.uc.edu
Dan Nassirharand	nassirdl@mail.uc.edu

2. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

Lead Developer/Architect

Oversees system architecture, technical decisions, and integration points with GE Appliances infrastructure.

QA/Test Owner

Leads testing strategy, manages test cases, and evaluates developer productivity improvements.

Documentation Owner: Maintains technical documentation, design specifications, and ensures code comments are clear and up-to-date.

Coordinator Tracks: Manages project timeline, tracks progress, coordinates meetings, and serves as primary contact with GE Appliances stakeholders.

The following roles rotate approximately every 3-4 weeks to ensure both members develop skills across all areas: **Shared Responsibilities:** Both members are responsible for documentation quality, testing rigor, and code standards regardless of current role assignment.

3. COMMUNICATION CHANNELS & RESPONSE EXPECTATIONS

Primary Channel: Slack (immediate decisions, quick questions)

Response Time: Non-urgent messages within 24 hours; urgent/blocking issues flagged and responded to within 4 hours when possible

Secondary Channel: Email (formal documentation, longer-form discussion)

Team/Advisor Meetings: Meetings are every weekday with our advisor at 8:30 AM. If unable to connect, we will share a written update over Teams chat or email.

Faculty Advisor Meetings: Scheduled by advisor if more time is needed; both members attend

4. DECISION-MAKING PROCESS

Technical decisions within each member's domain area (AI stream vs. Food & Global stream rest with that member. Cross-domain decisions require consensus.

Major decisions (approach changes, scope changes, major design overhauls) require discussion and written agreement from both team members.

If consensus cannot be reached, both perspectives are documented, and the faculty advisor provides final guidance.

5. CONFLICT RESOLUTION & ESCALATION

Step 1: Direct discussion. If a disagreement arises, the affected members discuss it in person or via video call (not async) and document the discussion.

Step 2: Written proposal. If unresolved, the proposing member writes up their position and reasoning.

Step 3: Advisor escalation. If still unresolved within 48 hours, the issue is brought to the faculty advisor for guidance.

All team members commit to respectful, solution-oriented discussions.

6. ATTENDANCE & ACCOUNTABILITY

All scheduled team and advisor meetings are mandatory. If unable to attend, notify the other member and advisor as far in advance as possible.

Each member commits to completing their assigned work on schedule and to raising blockers or delays within 24 hours of awareness.

7. ACKNOWLEDGMENT & SIGNATURES

By signing below, each team member acknowledges that they have read this contract, understand the expectations, and agree to uphold these commitments for the duration of the senior design project.

Dan Nassirharand

Dan Nassirharand

Signature

Date: 09/15/2026

Maxwell Blevins

Maxwell Blevins

Signature

Date: 09/15/2026